

Keerti Mehta
Computer Engineering

Company: General Mills
Job Profile: Software Developer
Offer Type: Internship Only
Internship Stipend: Rs.35,000
CTC:
Location: Mumbai
Process Date: 14th September,2024

Placement Process:

1. Round 1 Online Assessment [All who registered]

The online assessment round consisted of 60 questions and had a duration of 1 hour and 10 minutes. There were three sections: logical reasoning, language proficiency and technical questions.

Logical reasoning: This section was of 15 minutes(15 questions) and it contained basic questions related to math, patterns, sequences. The 15 minutes time was less for this section.

Language proficiency: This section was of 15 minutes(15 questions) and it contained questions related to basic English. The time was sufficient for solving this section.

Technical questions: This section was of 40 minutes(30 questions). It contained questions ranging from topics of Database Management System, Computer Communication and Networks, Object Oriented Programming, Operating Systems and Data Structures and Algorithms.

2. Technical Round [18 students were shortlisted for this round]

This round lasted for 45 mins to 1 hour . The interviewer began by asking which subject excites me the most and I chose App development. I was given a case study to design an app. The task began with me asking relevant questions to understand the requirements thoroughly. I had to consider factors like the app's functionality, user experience, and the overall system architecture. Once I had enough information, I proposed a design that detailed both the frontend and backend components, explaining how they would interact. A key focus was on scaling the app from 3,000 to 30,000 users, and I discussed strategies like efficient data storage, user management, and backend optimization to handle the increased load. The interviewer tested my ability to break down the problem, gather requirements, and present a robust, scalable solution.

Following this, I was asked about storing large amounts of data using Firebase, which had been a core part of my previous app development experience. The interviewer wanted to understand if I knew how to handle scalability issues in Firebase, especially with large databases. I explained Firebase's strengths in handling real-time data but also discussed its limitations when it comes to scaling beyond certain thresholds. This led to a deeper conversation about database management, where I was quizzed on concepts like BCNF and normalization. I answered these questions, elaborating on whether normalization is needed for small databases. While I wasn't very familiar with microservices, the interviewer was helpful in explaining key concepts, and I picked up the basics quickly, which allowed me to respond to further questions.

Toward the end of the interview, the case study was revealed to be based on an app the interviewer had already developed, providing a real-world context to the task. I asked how they had solved the scalability problem in their app and was curious about their experience at General Mills. The interview tested my ability to think critically, learn on the go and apply theoretical knowledge to practical challenges. It wasn't just about technical expertise but also about showing my problem-solving skills and willingness to engage with new concepts and feedback. Overall, it was an insightful experience that showcased my strengths and highlighted areas where I could continue to grow.

3. **HR- Based Round**[10 students were shortlisted for this round]

In my HR interview, the panel consisted of two interviewers who started by asking me to introduce myself and share a bit about my family background. After that, they posed an interesting question—if I hadn't chosen to pursue engineering, what other career path would I have taken. They then moved on to ask where I see myself in the next five years and how my friends would describe me, giving me a chance to reflect on both my professional goals and my personal traits.

The interview then touched on some of the major decisions I've made, as they asked me about the easiest and most difficult decisions I've taken so far in life. I was also asked to explain about one of my projects in brief. Finally, I was asked why I wanted to join General Mills, which allowed me to express my interest in the company. At the end of the interview, I had the opportunity to ask them questions.

The key is to stay calm and maintain a friendly smile throughout the process. Answer the questions confidently and ensure that your responses reflect genuine interest while aligning with the company's values and goals.

4 students were offered internships after this round.

Useful Tips:

- Know your basic concepts: Be well-versed in the fundamentals of CCN (Computer Communication Networks), OS (Operating Systems), DBMS (Database Management Systems), and Data Structures.
- Aptitude practice: Practice sequences, patterns, and work-related problems on various aptitude websites to sharpen your problem-solving skills.
- Focus on DBMS: Pay special attention to normalization in DBMS as it is a key concept often discussed.
- Prepare for technical rounds: Be thorough with the projects mentioned in your resume and be ready to explain them in detail.
- Master the basics: Ensure you have a strong understanding of core concepts, even in areas outside your projects.
- Curiosity matters: If you're unsure about an answer, show curiosity and eagerness to learn more about it. This reflects a positive attitude towards learning.
- Be engaged and eager: Show genuine interest in whatever the interviewers explain and ask thoughtful follow-up questions.
- Stay confident: Maintain confidence throughout the interview, as it can leave a lasting impression.